

Friendly reminder that ChatGPT consumes over half a million kilowatts of electricity each day

Posted by u/suresher • 0 points • 27 comments

Please limit your ChatGPT usage to save the earth :)

Comments

u/Penultimate74 • 1 points • 2024-10-15 13:28 UTC

Let the billionaires figure it out. I'm a consumer.

u/Coamlthra • 1 points • 2024-10-15 07:46 UTC

Bit of a tangent, but nuclear is not a great solution. We all know about the waste and risk of catastrophic failure, and the effects of those have been overstated (although it is hard to reason about toxic waste that will last as long as current human history), but there are more practical concerns.

When taking the cost of building and maintaining power plants into account, the price per kWh is prohibitively high. And because these things are expensive megaprojects, there are no real economies of scale in play. Building more does not tend to make them cheaper.

Indeed, building more would increase the price further, as they require rare resources to operate (uranium).

On the bright side, solar power does benefit from rapid iteration and improvement, and has little environmental impact or rare resource requirements.

u/goodguy5000hd • 2 points • 2024-10-14 21:08 UTC

All living environmentalists are hypocrites: ruining their "Garden of Eden" with their very existence.

Build more power sources, especially nuclear. Human quality of life depends on cheap power.

u/considerthis8 • 1 points • 2024-10-14 17:00 UTC

According to io-preview: for an average response it consumes 0.00008kWh = \$0.00001

u/Coamlthra • 7 points • 2024-10-14 12:04 UTC

A quick Google suggests ChatGPT uses a bit less than 1GWh (the h is important) per day for a total of 225 GWh per year. Definitely a lot!

That's 80 billion prompts, for 0.0028 kWh per prompt.

A vacuum cleaner is about 1 kW. So a prompt uses the same amount of energy of leaving your vacuum on for .0028 hours (10 seconds).

For another reference point (and related to the veganism argument above), a pound of beef takes 31 kWh to produce (or 11,000 prompts).

Math is fun!

u/UltraBabyVegeta • 4 points • 2024-10-14 10:54 UTC

Gonna use it even more now cause of you

u/Stuf404 • 1 points • 2024-10-14 10:30 UTC

That's roughly 4,545,454 UK kettles boiling 1 litre of water each.

Equals roughly 18,181,816 cups of tea per day. More if it's with Sports direct mugs, by a factor of 1000.

u/After-right • 2 points • 2024-10-14 10:30 UTC

Shut the fuck up